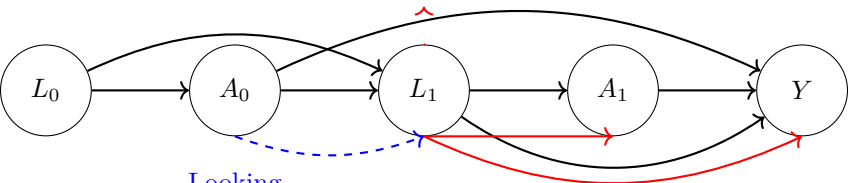


The Problem Variable



Looking backward, L_1 is a **mediator** of A_0 's effect. Adjusting for it blocks this causal path.

Looking forward, L_1 is a **confounder** for A_1 's effect. We must adjust for it to block the backdoor path.